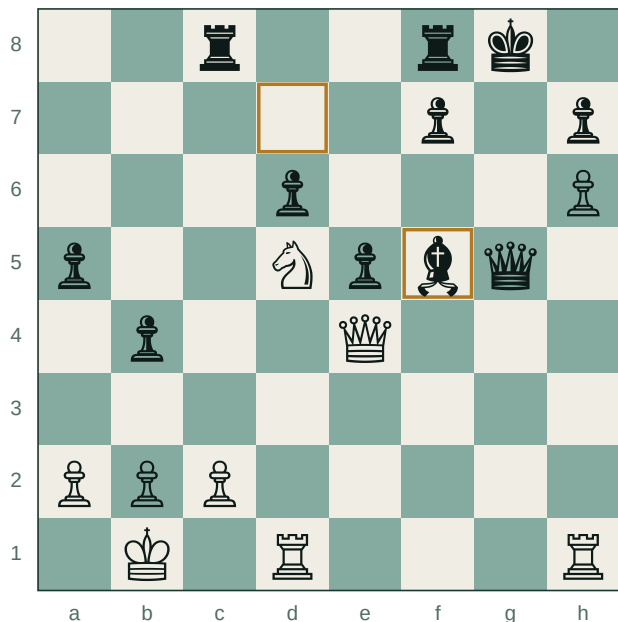


Attraction tactics: White, move 24

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 23...Bf5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

24. Qxf5 25. Ne7+ Kh8 26. Nxf5

24.Qxf5 The queen captures the bishop on f5. From f5 it attacks queen on g5 and rook on c8. Recorded reply: **24...Qxf5**.

25.Ne7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From e7 it attacks king on g8, queen on f5 and rook on c8. Recorded reply: **25...Kh8**.

26.Nxf5 The knight captures the queen on f5.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: queen on g5. Check for tactical protection.